

in Pali district near Sumerpur town. Rich in biodiversity, it has become the haunt of leopards, birds, hyena, white fox, sloth bear, and so on. The famous Rabari tribe hails from here. Noted for its frequent leopard sightings, Jawai is visited by nature lovers and wildlife enthusiasts throughout the year.

Tal Chhapar Sanctuary

A safe haven for black bucks and a variety of birds, this sanctuary set on the fringes of the desert is named after Chhapar village. Located in the Sujangarh Tehsil of Churu, it is 210 kilometres from Jaipur. Its open grasslands scattered with trees give it the appearance of a savannah. The sanctuary is a bird watcher's paradise, home to species like the eastern imperial eagle, black ibis, demoiselle cranes, skylarks, ring doves and more. One can also spot the desert fox and desert cat here.

Jhalana Safari Park

The Jhalana Safari Park in Jaipur is an expansive safari park popular for leopard sightings. The forest block has an area of 1,978 hectares and is situated on the south-eastern border of Jaipur city. The safari tour lets visitors witness wildlife in its natural habitat. Besides leopards, the safari also has panthers, hyenas, foxes, jackals, spotted deer, etc. It's also a bird watcher's paradise, home to Indian Pitta, Dusky Eagle, Spotted Owlet, Indian roller, shikra, hawks, etc. There are a few popular places of interest in the park too; namely, a majestic shikar oudhi built in 1835 by Sawai Ram Singh, a Kali temple and a Jain Chulgiri temple.

Amagarh Leopard Reserve

Rajasthan's latest leopard safari was inaugurated on International Biological Biodiversity Day (May 22) this year. Set in the Amagarh hills in the Aravali range in Jaipur, the safari is spread over 1,524 hectares and provides shelter to 16 leopards and 250 species of birds. Several water points have been set up for the leopards, and for tourists to spot them. Located midway between Jhalana, Rajasthan's first leopard reserve, and the Nahargarh Sanctuary, Amagarh is critical from a wildlife conservation and corridor development perspective.

Mukundara Hills Tiger Reserve

The Mukundara Hills Tiger Reserve is 50 kilometres from Kota. Tigers are often relocated here from Ranthambore. It has a core area of 417 sq km and a buffer zone covering 342.82 sq km. Other wildlife includes panther, deer, wild boar and bear. This thickly wooded area is home to a large variety of birds as well.

There are many other sanctuaries and wildlife habitats of note in Rajasthan, including the National Chambal Wildlife Sanctuary and the Sambhar Salt Lake, a saline wetland 74 kilometres west of Jaipur which attracts thousands of flamingoes and other bird species in the winters.





KEOLADEO GHANA NATIONAL PARK

This is one of the great birding destinations of the world. Every year, thousands of migratory birds such as green sandpiper and cranes visit the park during the winter. It was created in the mid-18th century as a small reservoir located five kilometres to the southeast of Bharatpur. The construction of the Ajan Bund (dam) and the subsequent flooding of this natural depression led to one of the world's most fascinating and spectacular bird reserves.

